

On the sidelines of Acer's annual GPC (Global Press Conference) called Next@

Acer, we got the opportunity to speak to Andrew Hou, President, Pan-Asia Pacific Operations about Acer's new online store in India and how they're aligning their product portfolio for the new normal.

Q Is Acer focusing on its own store as the primary e-commerce platform for all Acer products or will you continue relying on your channel partners. Also, what additional benefit can you provide the customers via the Acer store that you can't provide via the existing platforms?

Andrew: Let me talk about India. We're working with local e-tailers very closely and definitely don't wish to create conflicts in our supply chain. In India, we will introduce new products via the Acer website and we will also have sales of refurbished products via the Acer Store. We will certainly have some type of channel differentiation for our local partners. We don't want to be competition to our local partners. Our idea for the Acer website is for it to become a source of traffic so that we can tell our stories and put out fresh information in the market for the sake of our customers. It will also help our partners to sell more products.

Q Certain brands such as Xiaomi have started bringing in laptops with good specs at really competitive prices. What's your take on the same?

Andrew: Acer has a very rich product portfolio with plenty of products in the entry level segment with SSDs. I'm not sure about the price competition yet. Normally, when Xiaomi starts selling a new product it does so by losing money and that's why they can have very cheap products. I'm not sure if we want to compete head-to-head with Xiaomi yet. We are certainly watching them closely and we have similar

Tech for the new normal



Andrew Hou,
President, Pan-Asia Pacific Operations

The pandemic has changed a lot of sectors this year, here's Acer's take on how they're dealing with the new normal

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configuration products in our portfolio as well.

Q What has been the impact of the Covid-19 pandemic and the US-China trade wars? We have seen consumers opting to buy only what is necessary rather than spending more for luxury purchases. Is Acer modifying its portfolio to meet this shift in market forces?

Andrew: Because of the trade wars and the pandemic, people's purchasing behaviour has indeed seen a shift. For example, we launched the Swift 5 which has a anti-microbial coating. Our idea is that in the future, all the products will have such an anti-microbial coating. Secondly, people are buying more from online channels and more people are getting



Acer Swift 5 with anti-microbial coating

online. So all the promotions and purchasing is going shifting online. Our idea is to be more digital when we talk about products and their specifications. Entire communication for brands has shifted online. Even we held our annual GPC (Global Press Conference) online and I don't think any other brand has done the same. So this was a good experience for Acer and we like to get much closer to the end-user as we tell our story.

Q At the GPC, you also hinted at more innovations in your product portfolio akin to the anti-microbial coating that's in the works. Could you elaborate on those?

Andrew: We can't disclose that right now. It's better to wait for the next GPC. **Q**